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Running belt

Abstract

A running belt has a pouch that defines a primary compartment sized to receive at least a smartphone therein, and there is a divider within the compartment to divide the compartment into a front portion and a rear portion, wherein at least one of the front portion and the rear portion is adapted to retain the smartphone therein, and the divider defines an interior pocket that is divided into at least two portions by a panel within the pocket of the divider, and the pocket is sized to receive an item that is smaller than the smartphone therein, and the panel maintains a substantially constant shape of the divider when the item is inserted into or removed from the pocket and when the smartphone is inserted into or removed from the primary compartment.

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Background/Summary

REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation-in-part and claims the benefit of U.S. Design Application Serial Number 29/834,015, filed on Apr. 8, 2022; the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This disclosure is directed to a running belt.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) Carrying a cell phone while exercising offers several benefits and reasons why individuals choose to have their phone with them. First, it offers accessibility. By keeping the cell phone and keys on their person, individuals can quickly access important information or make necessary calls or messages during their exercise sessions without interrupting the workout. Second, it allows the tracking of fitness data. Fitness apps and wearable devices can track and monitor various exercise metrics, such as distance, pace, heart rate, and calories burned. Carrying a cell phone allows individuals to utilize these apps and devices to gather and analyze data, monitor their progress, and set fitness goals. Third, it provides safety and communication. Carrying a cell phone ensures individuals can reach out for help or assistance in case of an emergency or unexpected situation. It provides a sense of security, especially when exercising alone or in remote areas. Fourth, it enables the enjoyment of music and entertainment. Many people enjoy listening to music or podcasts while exercising to enhance their workout experience and stay motivated. Having a cell phone on hand allows immediate access to favorite playlists or entertainment options. Fifth, it offers connection through social media. Carrying a cell phone ensure that individuals can taking pictures, texting, answering an email, or posting on social media based on where the person is or what they are doing—Snapchat, Instagram, Twitter, Facebook, while out, or during a running event, etc.

(3) In addition to carrying a cell phone, individuals have other devices available for conveniently carrying or holding their cell phones (and keys or wallet/cash/credit cards) while exercising. Some exemplary devices are clips or armbands. Clips or holders are compact and lightweight devices that can be attached directly to clothing, such as waistbands or bra straps, keeping the cell phone or keys securely in place. Clips or holders provide a minimalist solution for individuals who prefer to keep their items within easy reach. Armbands are worn around the upper arm and feature a pocket or pouch to hold the cell phone. They offer a hands-free option, keeping the phone accessible without interfering with movement. Armbands are popular among runners and individuals engaging in arm-intensive exercises.

(4) Other devices such as running belts or waistbands, which are specifically designed for carrying cell phones and keys during exercise. Running belts or waistbands are constructed with lightweight and moisture-wicking materials to ensure comfort and prevent irritation during physical activities. Typically, they offer the advantages such as being stretchable bands that can be adjusted to fit around the waist or hips, providing flexibility and a snug fit. Elastic waistbands often feature pockets to securely hold the cell phone and keys, preventing them from bouncing or shifting while running. Further, many running belts or waistbands come with zippered pouches that provide additional security for the stored items. The zipper ensures that the belongings stay in place, even during vigorous movements. These pouches may have separate compartments to keep the cell phone and keys organized. Still further, some running belts or waistbands feature expandable pockets that can accommodate larger cell phones or other items like energy gels, small water bottles, or wallets. They use stretchable materials or adjustable straps to hold the contents securely. Also, for safety purposes, some running belts or waistbands may incorporate reflective elements such as strips or logos. These increase visibility during low-light conditions, making the wearer more easily seen by motorists or other pedestrians.

(5) Although running belts or waistbands are advantageous, they are not without their drawbacks. Running belts typically provide a limited amount of storage space compared to other carrying options like backpacks or hydration vests. If an individual needs to carry larger items such as water bottles or extra gear, a running belt may not be sufficient. Depending on the design and placement of the pockets, accessing items stored in a running belt can be somewhat cumbersome during a workout. It may require slowing down, stopping, or adjusting the belt to retrieve or stow away items, which can interrupt the flow of exercise. Despite efforts to create a snug fit, some running belts may still experience bouncing or shifting during vigorous activities, particularly if they are not properly adjusted or secured. This movement can be distracting or uncomfortable, potentially affecting the overall workout experience.

(6) There are compromises to be made when choosing current running belts or waist packs/fanny packs. For instance, the most stretchy and breathable fabrics may not be sweat or weather resistant. Options that use zippers have constrictive openings. Fixed loops aren't adjustable and may be awkward to put on or step into. They may incorporate divider materials that don't stretch so they compromise the stretch of any stretchy material to which they are sewn.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(7) The running belt or waistband detailed in the exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure addresses the drawbacks of previous configurations. The present disclosure provides varying examples of a running belt or waistband that addresses these drawbacks through innovative features such as anti-bounce technology (i.e., bounce free), increased securement of devices or objects, improved accessibility, or added storage options. Exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure may provide a divider within a primary compartment of a pouch, wherein the construction and configuration of the divider enables the pouch to stretch four ways. The pouch has a top front panel or pocket flap that can be tightly pulled over the top. Then, adjusting the belt around the waist stretches the pouch four ways to allow the pouch to expand, while stretching to hold what's inside snugly against the body. The configurations of the embodiments of the running

belts shown herein preserves the maximum stretchiness and water-resistance of the outside pouch in a way that maximizes the performance of the running belt—snugginess around the waist, functionality of using the divider for leverage, maintaining the shape of the compartment when phone isn't inside to make getting phone back inside easier, keeping the pocket water-resistant—and making getting things in and out more easily and quickly because of this functionality.

(8) In one aspect, an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may provide a running belt or waistband that utilizes a combination of different materials that results in a running band that is bounce-free or substantially bounce-free (because these materials stretch but the materials provide enough support) when the belt is donned or worn by a user. The belt includes a divider within a main or primary compartment of a pouch. One embodiment has an opening to the primary compartment of the pouch that is a flap or overlap opening that may be selectively opened and closed and connected with a hook-and-loop closure but without a zipper such that the opening isn't constricted or too small for the largest phones, and a user does not have to pack, unpack, and repack or fuss around to access an object or device, such as a phone, which results in easy access. The embodiments detailed herein provide separation and organization, water resistance, comfort and adjustment.

(9) One exemplary divider in the primary compartment of the pouch of the running belt functions to divide the primary compartment of the pouch into a first portion (e.g., a front compartment) and a second portion (e.g., a rear compartment). The divider may have its own pocket, which may have a zippered opening. The divider may be formed with material that surrounds or shrouds a rigid, semi-rigid, semi-flexible, or flexible panel. The pocket of the divider may be defined between the panel and the material that shrouds or surrounds the same. The pocket in the divider may be considered to be a sub-pocket relative to the primary compartment inasmuch as it is a pocket within a pouch. The pocket in the divider (i.e., the sub-pocket) keeps anything inserted inside the zip pocket part of the divider like a key fob, keys, a wallet or a credit card. The panel in the pocket of the divider eliminates bulkiness and retains shape such that the divider substantially does not bulge on at least one side of the divider (such as the back side of the divider). The panel enables the divider to remain flat on the back side thereof. This enables the divider to not obstruct the user when the user desired to slide a phone back into the main or primary compartment because the stiffness of the material forming the panel in the divider maintains the back or front side of the divider, as the case may be, flat and smooth. In one embodiment, the panel in the divider is formed from polypropylene (PP). The PP panel in the divider can be used to maintain a device or objects in the first portion or front compartment of the primary compartment out of the way and it then holds the flat space between the divider and the body so it makes it easy to slide the phone back. The material of the divider that shrouds or surrounds the PP panel stretches and so it tends to hold the phone very secure against the body maintaining stability and lack of movement of the phone inside the pocket. The divider also maintains the pocket's flat shape after the phone is removed, which again, aids getting the phone back inside, while preventing anything else inside from rounding out/rolling up.

(10) Further, in this exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment, the PP panel in the divider is connected or stitched to the ends of the elastic belt that are located within the pocket defined by elastic or elastane (such as Spandex® or Lycra®) material that shrouds or surrounds the PP panel, and collectively form the divider. The divider with the PP panel is incorporated in a way that does not inhibit the stretchiness or stretchability of the belt outer material forming the primary pouch or pocket. For example, the PP panel inside the divider is attached to the elastic belt inside an elastane shroud. The PP panel is sewn to the ends of the belt in a way that allows the divider as a unit to stretch (and thus hold a phone or other object behind it and next to the body more securely) and it permits the neoprene pouch to stretch. Because the neoprene pouch can still stretch, and together with the fact that it is more sturdy as compared to spandex, the stretching of the pouch in four directions, mainly horizontally around the waist, holds everything inside tight against the body

when the elastic belt is stretched to secure the entire running belt around the waist because when the elastic belt is stretched, it also stretches the neoprene pouch. With the pouch stretched, it operates like a rubber band holding contents inside against the body. Thus, in this embodiment, if the PP panel was stitched to the pouch then the neoprene would not stretch horizontally and it would function no differently than nylon or some non-flexible, non-stretchable material, and then contents inside the pocket could bounce, which would be undesirable.

(11) In another aspect, an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may provide a running belt that has a pouch that defines a primary compartment sized to receive at least a smartphone therein, and there is a divider within the compartment to divide the compartment into a front portion and a rear portion, wherein at least one of the front portion and the rear portion is adapted to retain the smartphone therein, and the divider defines an interior pocket that is divided into at least two portions by a panel within the pocket of the divider, and the pocket is sized to receive an item that is smaller than the smartphone therein, and the panel maintains a substantially constant shape of the divider when the item is inserted into or removed from the pocket and when the smartphone is inserted into or removed from the primary compartment.

(12) In yet another aspect, an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may provide a running belt comprising: a pouch forming a primary compartment, and the primary compartment is adapted to carry a device; a divider within the pouch to divide the primary compartment into a first portion and a second portion, the divider comprising a panel surrounded by a first material, wherein a pocket is defined within the divider between the panel and the first material, and the pocket within the divider is adapted carry an item that is smaller than the device; and an adjustable belt connected to respective ends of the pouch and the belt is operable to retain the pouch about a portion of a user's body. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may further include a first surface on the panel; a second surface on the panel, wherein the second surface faces an opposite direction as the first surface; and a first portion of the first material proximate the first surface on the panel, wherein the first portion of the first material defines an opening that is selectively opened and closed. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may further include a zipper on the first portion of the first material that effectuates the opening to be selectively opened and closed. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may further provide that the zipper is laterally aligned. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may further include a first surface on the panel, wherein a first portion of the pocket within the divider is defined between the first surface of the panel and a front portion of the first material; and a second surface on the panel, wherein the second surface faces an opposite direction as the first surface, wherein a second portion of the pocket within the divider is defined between the second surface of the panel and a rear portion of the first material. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may provide that the pouch comprises a second material that is different than the first material. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may provide that the first material comprises elastane and the second material comprises neoprene. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may provide that the panel comprises PP. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may further include a top edge and a bottom edge on the panel; a first end and second end on the panel; and wherein the first end and the second end on the panel are directly or indirectly coupled to the first material, and the first material freely surrounds the top edge and the bottom edge on the panel. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may provide that the first material that freely surrounds the panel defines a front portion of the pocket and a rear portion of the pocket within the divider. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may further include a first end of the divider and second end of the divider; a top of the divider and a bottom of the divider; wherein the first end of the divider and the second end of the divider are directly or indirectly coupled with respective ends of the pouch; and wherein the pouch freely surrounds the top of the divider and the bottom of the divider, and wherein there is

no connection of the bottom of the divider to the pouch such that the first portion of the primary compartment is in open communication with the second portion of the primary compartment below the divider, and wherein there is no connection of the top of the divider to the pouch such that the first portion of the primary compartment is in open communication with the second portion of the primary compartment above the divider.

(13) In yet another aspect, an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may provide a method comprising: donning a belt having a pouch defining a primary compartment and having a divider located within the primary compartment, wherein the divider divides the primary compartment into a first portion and a second portion of the primary compartment; selectively inserting a device into either one of the first portion of the primary compartment or the second portion of the primary compartment; opening the divider to reveal a pocket within the divider; and inserting an item into the divider, wherein the item is smaller than the device. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may provide that the divider includes a panel that divides the pocket into a first portion and the second portion, the method further comprising selectively inserting the item into either one of the first portion of the pocket or the second portion of the pocket. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may further include stretching a first material that surrounds the panel and defines the divider in response to insertion of the item, wherein the panel has a top edge and a bottom edge, and has a first end and second end, and wherein the first end and the second end on the panel are directly or indirectly coupled to the first material, and the first material freely surrounds the top edge and the bottom edge on the panel. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may further include stretching a second material that forms the pouch in response to insertion of the device, wherein the divider has a top edge and a bottom edge, and the divider has a first end and second end, and wherein the first end and the second end on the divider are directly or indirectly coupled to the second material, and the second material freely surrounds the top edge and the bottom edge on the divider. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may provide that opening the divider to reveal a pocket within the divider is accomplished by unzipping a laterally aligned zipper on a frontal portion of the divider. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may further include flexing a panel located within the pocket of the divider prior to inserting the item into the pocket of the divider, wherein the panel is flexed prior to inserting the device into either one of the first portion of the primary compartment or the second portion of the primary compartment, wherein the panel is formed from PP. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may further include opening the pouch via an overlap opening on a frontal portion of the pouch to provide access to the primary compartment. This exemplary embodiment or another exemplary embodiment may further include maintaining an exterior profile shape of the divider via a panel located within the pocket of the divider when the item is inserted into the pocket of the divider and when the item is removed from the pocket of the divider.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Sample embodiments of the present disclosure are set forth in the following description, are shown in the drawings and are particularly and distinctly pointed out and set forth in the appended claims.

(2) FIG. 1 is a front elevation view of a running belt in accordance with one exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 is a rear elevation view thereof.

(4) FIG. 3 is a top plan view thereof.

(5) FIG. 4 is a bottom plan view thereof.

- (6) FIG. 5 is an enlarged first end elevation view thereof.
- (7) FIG. 6 is an enlarged second end elevation view thereof.
- (8) FIG. 7 is a cross section elevation view taken in the direction of line 7-7 in FIG. 5.
- (9) FIG. 8 is a cross section elevation view taken in the direction of line 8-8 in FIG. 5.
- (10) FIG. 9 is a cross section top plan view taken in the direction of line 9-9 in FIG. 1.
- (11) FIG. 10 is a cross section elevation view taken in the direction of line 10-10 in FIG. 6.
- (12) FIG. 11 is a cross section elevation view taken in the direction of line 11-11 in FIG. 6.
- (13) FIG. 12 is a cross section side elevation view take in the direction of line 12-12 in FIG. 1.
- (14) FIG. 13A is an operational diagrammatic side elevation view of the running belt with the divider being moved rearward.
- (15) FIG. 13B is an operational diagrammatic side elevation view of the running belt with a device, such as a phone, inserted into the primary compartment forward of the divider.
- (16) FIG. 14A is an operational diagrammatic side elevation view of the running belt with the divider being moved forward.
- (17) FIG. 14B is an operational diagrammatic side elevation view of the running belt with a device, such as a phone, inserted into the primary compartment rearward of the divider.
- (18) FIG. 15A is an operational diagrammatic side elevation view of the running belt with an item, such as a credit card, inserted into the pocket of the divider and forward of the panel.
- (19) FIG. 15B is an operational diagrammatic side elevation view of the running belt with an item, such as a credit card, inserted into the pocket of the divider and rearward of the panel.
- (20) FIG. 16 is an alternative embodiment of the panel.
- (21) FIG. 17 is a front elevation view of an alternative embodiment of a running belt having the panel of FIG. 16.
- (22) FIG. 18 is a diagrammatic cross section view of the alternative embodiment of the running belt taken in the direction of line 18-18 in FIG. 17.
- (23) FIG. 19 is a diagrammatic cross section view of the alternative embodiment of the running belt taken in the direction of line 19-19 in FIG. 18.
- (24) Similar numbers refer to similar parts throughout the drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(25) FIG. 1 through FIG. 10 depict one exemplary embodiment of a running belt generally at 10. Running belt 10 may also referred to generally as a waist band or, simply, belt 10. Thus, the term “running” should not be construed to be limiting as the belt 10 can be used for other activities for which a user or wearer of belt 10 desires to retain, carry or otherwise hold devices, objects or items with the belt. Further, while it is primarily envisioned that belt 10 will be word around a user's waist, it is to be understood that belt could be worn in different manners, such as a cross-body sling.

(26) Belt 10 includes a pouch 12 forming a primary compartment 14. The primary compartment 14 is adapted to carry a device, such as a cellphone or smartphone, wallet, or other similarly sized device. Belt 10 includes a divider 16 within the primary compartment 14 of pouch 12 to divide the primary compartment 14 into a front or first portion 14A and a rear or second portion 14B. The divider 16 includes a panel 18 surrounded or shrouded by a shroud 20 of first material. In one embodiment, the first material that forms the shroud 20 is elastane (e.g., LYCRA® or SPANDEX®) or comprises elastane or consists essentially of elastane. A pocket 22 is defined within the divider 16 and is located between the panel 18 and the first material of shroud 20. The pocket 22 within the divider is adapted carry an item that is smaller than the device. For example, the item carried within pocket 22 may be a key, credit card, coins, cash or other money, or other similarly sized item that is smaller than the device. Belt 10 also includes a belt 24. Belt 24 may be adjustable via adjustment slides 26 and releasably connected to itself via a connector 28. The belt 24 may be connected to respective ends 12A, 12B of the pouch 12 and the belt 24 is operable to retain the pouch about a portion of a user's body.

(27) FIG. 1 and FIG. 2 depict pouch **12** as laterally extending between first end **12A** and second end **12B**. Pouch **12** includes a top edge **12C** that extends in the lateral direction and a bottom edge **12D** that extends in the lateral direction vertically below top edge **12C**. Top edge **12C** has respective lateral ends that transition or taper downward to the first end **12A** and the second end **12B** respectively. The tapered end portions of the top edge **12C** may be formed by folding a portion of the different second material that forms the pouch **12**. In one particular embodiment, the different second material forming pouch **12** may be neoprene, comprise neoprene, consist neoprene, or consist essentially of neoprene. The bottom edge **12D** includes lateral ends that taper upward into the respective ends **12A**, **12B** and mirror that of the top edge **12C** relative to an imaginary horizontal centerline or horizontal axis **38** (see FIG. 10). Rear panel **12E** of the pouch **12** may be formed from a continuous piece of material as shown in FIG. 2. There may be two panels that collectively form the front panels of the pouch **12**. There may be a top front panel **12F** and a bottom front panel **12G** that define an opening to the primary compartment **14** therebetween. A pull-tab **30** may be in operative communication with a hook and loop connector **32** that selectively permit open and closure of the opening to the primary compartment between top front panel **12F** and bottom front panel **12G**. Pull-tab **30** extends vertically downward from the lower edge of the top front panel **12F**. The opening to the pouch **12** may be considered a flap opening or overlap opening based on the arrangement and configuration of the top front panel **12F** and bottom front panel **12G**.

(28) Overall the shape of the pouch **12** takes the form of an elongated octagon in which the outer perimeter of pouch **12** is symmetric relative to a horizontal axis **38** and symmetric relative to a vertical axis. However, other configurations of pouch **12** are entirely possible. For example pouch **12** could have a circular perimeter, a rectangular perimeter, or any other geometric configuration or shape that still includes the other features detailed herein.

(29) FIG. 7 through FIG. 10 depict the divider **16** within the primary compartment **14**. The divider **16** includes a first end **16A**, a second end **16B**, a top edge **16C**, and a bottom edge **16D**. Divider **16** includes a front surface **16E** opposite a rear surface **16F**. The first end **16A** and the second end **16B** may be indirectly coupled to the first end **12A** and the second end **12B** of the pouch **12**, respectively. In one particular embodiment, the first end **16A** of the divider **16** is fixedly connected via stitching or other mechanical or chemical connections to the belt **24** within the primary compartment **14**. In this particular embodiment, the second end **16B** of the divider **16** is fixedly connected by stitching or other mechanical or chemical connections to the belt **12** within the primary compartment **14**.

(30) As shown in FIG. 7 and FIG. 8, the divider has a vertical dimension measured between the top edge **16C** and the bottom edge **16D** that is less than the vertical dimension of the primary compartment **14** such that a space or top space **14C** of the primary compartment **14** is present between the top edge **16C** of divider **16** and the top edge **12C** of pouch **12**. Further, there is a space or bottom space **14D** between the bottom edge **16D** and the bottom edge **12D** of pouch **12**. The top space **14C** and the bottom space **14D** allow the front portion or first portion **14A** of the primary compartment **14** to be in open communication with the second portion or rear portion **14B** of the primary compartment **14**. More particularly, the top space **14C** establishes that there is no connection of the top edge **16C** of divider **16** to the pouch **12** such that the first portion **14A** of the primary compartment is in open communication with the second portion **14B** of the primary compartment above the divider **16**. Additionally, there is no connection of the bottom of the divider **16** to the pouch **12** such that the space **14D** causes the first portion **14A** of the primary compartment **14** to be in open communication with the second portion **14B** of the primary compartment **14** below the divider **16**.

(31) The shroud **20** includes a first end **20A** that is collocated with the first end **16A** of divider **16** and the shroud **20** includes a second end **20B** that is collocated with the second end **16B** of divider **16**. The respective ends **20A**, **20B** of shroud **20** are directly or indirectly coupled to pouch **12**. In

one particular embodiment, the ends **20A**, **20B** of shroud **20** are fixedly connected to the respective first and second ends **12A**, **12B** of pouch **12**. Shroud **20** includes a top edge **20C** and a bottom edge **20D**. As depicted in FIG. **10** and FIG. **11** the top edge **20C** and the bottom edge **20D** of shroud **20** freely surround the panel **18** and contact the panel **18** but are not fixedly connected thereto. This allows the panel **18** to freely move within the pocket **22** within the divider **16**, but also allows the first material to freely stretch relative to the panel **18**.

(32) The shroud **20** formed of the first material includes a front or first portion **20E** and a rear portion **20F**. There may be an opening **34** formed in the front portion **20E** that permits access to the pocket **22** within the divider **16**. The opening **34** may be a laterally aligned or horizontally aligned zippered opening effectuated by zipper **36**.

(33) With continued reference to FIG. **10** and FIG. **11**, panel **18** includes a first end **18A** and a second end **18B**. Panel **18** includes a top edge **18C** and a bottom edge **18D**. The first end **18A** of panel **18** is connected with an end **24A** of belt **24** within pocket **22** of divider **16**. The second end **18B** of panel **18** is connected to a second end **24B** of belt **24** within the pocket **22** of divider **16**. The connections of the ends **24A**, **24B** of belt **24** to the panel **18** may be accomplished through stitching or another mechanical, chemical, or non-mechanical and non-chemical connection manners. Stated otherwise, the ends **24A**, **24B** of belt **24** are disposed within the pocket **22** defined by the first material forming shroud **20** of divider **16**.

(34) The panel **18** has a generally rectangular configuration that is horizontally elongated. Panel **18** is formed from a semi-flexible material that retains its shape under ordinary forces, however is able to be flexed or bent in response to a force that overcomes the strength of the material. One exemplary material that forms panel **18** is polypropylene (PP). The PP material forming panel **18** allow the panel to retain its shape within the first material that forms shroud **20** and allows it to remain horizontally elongated in a generally rectangular configuration as shown in FIG. **10** and FIG. **11**. The orientation of the panel **18** causes the divider to have an elongated octagonal configuration as shown in FIG. **10** and FIG. **11**, as well as shown in FIG. **7** and FIG. **8**.

(35) FIG. **10** depicts that the top edge **20C** of shroud **20** tapers at respective ends of the shroud **20** relative to horizontal axis **38**. The tapering portion of the top edge **20C** of shroud **20** that is associated with the first end **20A** of shroud **20** tapers along plane **40**. Plane **40** intersects horizontal axis **38** at an angle **42**. Angle **42** may in a range from about 15 degrees to about 45 degree. However, other angles are entirely possible for angle **42**. For example, in one particular embodiment angle **42** defined between plane **40** and horizontal axis **38** is about 40 degrees. In one particular embodiment, the tapering portion associated with the second end **20B** of shroud **20** tapers at a similar angle relative to horizontal axis **38**.

(36) Panel **18** includes a vertical dimension **44** and a lateral dimension **46**. The vertical dimension **44** of panel **18** may be in a range from about 2 inches to about 4 inches. In one particular embodiment, the vertical dimension **44** of panel **18** is approximately 2.75 inches. The lateral dimension **46** of panel **18** may be in a range from about 4 inches to about 8 inches. In one particular embodiment, the lateral dimension **46** of panel **18** is approximately 6 inches. Panel **18** may have rounded corners **18E** when panel **18** is arranged or configured as a laterally elongated rectangle. Panel **18** has a first or front surface **18G** that is bound by the first end **18A**, second end **18B**, top edge **18C**, bottom edge **18D**, and rounded corners **18E**. Panel **18** has a second or rear surface **18F** that is bound by the first end **18A**, second end **18B**, top edge **18C**, bottom edge **18D**, and rounded corners **18E**. The first or front surface **18G** faces an opposite direction as the second or rear surface **18F**. A first or front portion **22A** of pocket **22** is defined between the first or front surface **18G** of panel **18** and the front portion **20E** of shroud **20**. A second or rear portion **22B** of pocket **22** is defined between the second or rear surface **18F** of panel **18** and the rear portion **20F** of shroud **20**.

(37) Panel **18** (and panel **118**, introduced below) may be formed of any suitable rigid or semi-rigid material having lower coefficient of friction (COF) than the material layers that form the pouch **12**, and having high durability. The panel **18** may line or divide the interior of pocket **22**, as discussed

herein, and the rigidity of the material selected for panel **18** may support the structure of divider **16** when an item is not inserted therein. According to one aspect, panel **18** may be formed of a material having a low COF such as a polymer plastic, or other similar material. As used herein, a low COF (i.e. the ratio between friction force and normal force) is contemplated to include materials with a COF below 1, where a coefficient of 1 represents the point where friction force is equal to the gravity force of the weight of the material. In one particular embodiment, panel **18** is formed of PP. PP is a tough, durable, and flexible polymer that may impart some flexible rigidity into divider **16** while having a low COF to allow for ease of insertion and removal of items therefrom. PP, like all materials, has a varying COF dependent upon the type of material the PP interacts with; however, generally speaking, PP has an approximate dynamic COF between 0.28 (plastics to steel) to 0.44 (plastics to plastic) and a static COF of 0.30 (plastics to steel) to 0.76 (plastics to plastics). For reference, materials with a COF below 0.1 are considered lubricous materials (e.g. lubricants).

(38) Having thus describe the exemplary configuration of belt **10**, reference is now made to its operation and shown in FIG. **13A**-FIG. **15B**.

(39) In operation and with reference to FIG. **13A** and FIG. **13B**, a user or wear of belt **10** will don the belt **10** on their body, typically around their waist. The user may pull the pull tab **30** to release the connector **32** on top panel **12F** from its connection with the corresponding connector **32** on bottom panel **12G**. Once the connection of connectors **32** is release, the top panel **12F** will be moved upward in the direction of Arrow A. The upward movement of top panel **12F** will expose the opening to the primary compartment **14**. With the top panel **12F** raised in an upward or opened position, the user will move or press the divider in the rearward direction, as indicated by Arrow B. The movement of divider in the rearward direction of Arrow B will enlarge the frontal portion **14A** of primary compartment **14** and decrease the rear portion **14B** of the primary compartment **14**. Then, with the divider **16** having moved from its normal or central position to a rear position, the user may insert a device **1** into the front portion **14A** of primary compartment **14**. Device **1** is diagrammatically shown but shall be understood to be a phone, smartphone, wallet or other similarly sized device that may fit within primary compartment **14**. Thereafter, with the device **1** disposed in the front portion **14A** of primary compartment **14**, the user may move and return the top panel **12F** to its previous position to connect connectors **32** to secure and close the flap opening of pouch **12**.

(40) In operation and with reference to FIG. **14A** and FIG. **14B**, a user or wear of belt **10** will don the belt **10** on their body, typically around their waist. The user may pull the pull tab **30** to release the connector **32** on top panel **12F** from its connection with the corresponding connector **32** on bottom panel **12G**. Once the connection of connectors **32** is release, the top panel **12F** will be moved upward in the direction of Arrow A. The upward movement of top panel **12F** will expose the opening to the primary compartment **14**. With the top panel **12F** raised in an upward or opened position, the user will move or press the divider in the forward direction, as indicated by Arrow C. The movement of divider in the forward direction of Arrow C will enlarge the rear portion **14B** of primary compartment **14** and decrease the forward portion **14A** of the primary compartment **14**. Then, with the divider **16** having moved from its normal or central position to a forward position, the user may insert the device **1** into the rear portion **14B** of primary compartment **14**. Thereafter, with the device **1** disposed in the rear portion **14B** of primary compartment **14**, the user may move and return the top panel **12F** to its previous position to connect connectors **32** to secure and close the flap opening of pouch **12**.

(41) In addition to that which is shown in FIG. **13A**-FIG. **14B**, the primary compartment **14** may hold, secure and/or retain two devices **1**. One device may be located forward of the divider **16** in the front portion **14A** of the primary compartment **14** and another device may be located rearward of the divider in the rear portion **14B** of the primary compartment **14**. Because the pouch **12** freely surrounds the top portion **16C** of divider **16** and freely surrounds the bottom edge **16D** of divider **16**, the second material forming pouch **12** can stretch and flex to permit the two devices to be

snuggly secured in the primary compartment with the divider **16** located between the two devices. This arrangement also allows the second material, such as neoprene (closed cell material and waterproof), to not be compromised by small holes from the stitch punctures which can allow moisture to get into the pocket, and therefore, the design without stitching, whereby a single piece of neoprene wrapped over itself to form a protective hood over the opening allows maximum protection from sweat and weather. In this embodiment when two devices **1** (or objects) are used, one of the devices will likely be a cell phone whereas the other device will be another object, such as lip balm, food, snacks, or another object larger than item **2**.

(42) In operation and with reference to FIG. **15A**, when the user has pulled the pull tab **30** to release the connector **32** on top panel **12F** from its connection with the corresponding connector **32** on bottom panel **12G** to open the pouch (or opened the pouch in any other manner), the divider will be exposed and accessible to the user. The user will open the opening **34** in the divider by moving the zipper **36** in a lateral direction. Alternatively, the user may open the opening **34** in any other known manner if the zipper **36** is not present. When the opening **34** is opened, the user has access to the pocket **22** within the divider **16**. Because the panel **18** is flexible or moveable, the user may push the panel rearward to enlarge the front portion **22A** of pocket **22**. This allows the user to insert an item **2** that is smaller than device **1**, such as cash, coins, keys, or a credit card into the front portion **22A** of pocket **22** (as seen in FIG. **15A**). Alternatively, the user may push the panel forward to enlarge the rear portion **22B** of pocket **22**. This allows the user to insert the item **2** into the rear portion **22B** of pocket **22** (as seen in FIG. **15B**).

(43) In addition to that which is shown in FIG. **15A**-FIG. **15B**, the pocket **22** may hold, secure and/or retain two items **2**. One item may be located forward of the panel **18** in the front portion **22A** of the pocket **22** and another item may be located rearward of the panel **18** in the rear portion **22B** of the pocket **22**. Because the shroud **20** of first material freely surrounds the top edge **18C** of panel **18** and freely surrounds the bottom portion **18D** of panel **18**, the first material forming shroud **20** can stretch and flex to permit the two items to be snugly secured in the pocket **22** with the panel **18** located between the two items. Alternatively, pocket **22** may function as containment area as extra security for primary compartment **14**, the pocket **22** keeping small things (i.e., items **2**) out of the way, and valuables extra secure for peace of mind, and with no worries of them accidentally falling out when something from primary compartment **14** is retrieved. The shroud being expandable can fit more items **2** (and bulge out to the front if needed).

(44) Furthermore, the each of the shown configurations carrying either the device **1** or the item **2** can be combined with any other configuration. For example, the belt **10** may be utilized to carry one device **1** in the front portion **14A** of the primary compartment and one item **2** in the front portion **22A** of the pocket **22**. The belt **10** may be utilized to carry one device **1** in the front portion **14A** of the primary compartment and one item **2** in the rear portion **22B** of the pocket **22**. The belt **10** may be utilized to carry one device **1** in the rear portion **14B** of the primary compartment and one item **2** in the front portion **22A** of the pocket **22**. The belt **10** may be utilized to carry one device **1** in the rear portion **14B** of the primary compartment and one item **2** in the rear portion **22B** of the pocket **22**.

(45) According to one exemplary aspect, the PP panel **18** is advantageous to managing getting the phone or object back into the primary compartment **14** more easily. The panel maintains the shape of the compartment **14** when the object **1** such as a phone is not inside. The panel **18** flexes to push the divider **16** forward and assists to place the object **1** inside the compartment **14**. The panel **18** pushes the stretchy, sticky, rubbery, flexible neoprene (i.e., second material) out of the way along the entire shape of the panel **18** to push those flexible materials out of the way while opening the compartment the entire length of the panel **18**, which manages the neoprene (i.e., second material) in a way that facilitates getting the phone or object **1** inside the compartment **14**. This configuration manages and accounts for the flexible, stretchy neoprene second material without compromising the waterproof nature thereof. In another embodiment, a fixed panel (i.e., the panel stitched to the

neoprene second material) could accomplish a similar objective but then there would be the compromise of stitching the outside neoprene (i.e., the stitching could reduce the waterproof capabilities).

(46) The PP panel makes it easy for the user to get the phone or object **1** into primary compartment **14** without compromising the beneficial stretchiness horizontally which helps hold contents inside securely. The belt **10** holds the phone or object **1** securely inside compartment **14** even with the flap open b/c the divider stretches and holds the phone securely against the body with the flap (i.e., top front panel **12F**) open. The zippered pocket still permits the divider **16** to stretch because the panel **18** is attached to the elastic belt **24** on the inside of the pocket **22**. Together, these allow the user to leverage the stretchiness of the materials in a way that allows the user to see inside easily, stretch the materials wide to fit things inside while wearing the belt **10**, keeps things secure, and not compromise the outside neoprene second material with stitching.

(47) Additionally, the belt **10** may be utilized to carry two or more devices **1** (at least one device **1** in the front portion **14A** of the primary compartment and at least one device **1** in the rear portion **14B** of the primary compartment) and one item **2** in the front portion **22A** of the pocket **22**. The belt **10** may be utilized to carry two or more devices **1** (at least one device **1** in the front portion **14A** of the primary compartment and at least one device in the rear portion **14B** of the primary compartment) and one item **2** in the rear portion **22B** of the pocket **22**. The belt **10** may be utilized to carry one device **1** in either the front portion **14A** or the rear portion **14B** of the primary compartment and two or more items **2** in the pocket **22** (at least one item **2** in the front portion **22A** and at least one item **2** in the rear portion **22B**).

(48) FIG. 16-FIG. 19 depicts an alternative embodiment of a running belt **110** that utilizes many of the same features of belt **10** and parts having similar reference elements are not repeated for brevity. Running belt **110** utilizes a panel **118** that is not located in a divider but rather affixed to the front lower panel **112G** on the interior surface thereof to line or define or bound primary compartment **114** of pouch **112**. Panel **118** may be formed from a PP material and have the same height dimension and lateral dimension as panel **18**. Panel **118** affixed to the interior surface of lower front portion **112G** would be stitched or attached to the tab **118A** at its top edge. The remaining perimeter of panel **118** is not affixed to the lower front portion **112G** of pouch **112**. This allows the second material that forms pouch **112** to stretch. With the panel **118** only sewn along its tab **118A** at the top edge, the pouch **112** would be able to stretch but still retain an overall flat configuration when viewed from the front to provide a sufficient structural shape to the primary compartment **114** when a device is inside the compartment **114**. The panel **118** that is only stitched along the tab **118A** at its top edge to the lower front portion **112G** would keep the primary compartment relatively flat when the belt **110** is worn by the user and makes it easy to facilitate inserting and retrieving the device from the primary compartment **114**.

(49) One exemplary advantage of belt **10** is that the materials and configuration of divider **16** within the primary compartment **14** of pouch **12** may offer ergonomic benefits based on the natural positioning of the belt around a user's waist (or other part of their body) when inserting a device or removing a device from the pouch **12**. The configuration of pouch **12** with the divider **16** takes advantage of the biometric alignment of the wrist and arm relative to an operational position of belt **10** resulting in improved comfort and reduced strain. Further, there may be some other benefits of the configuration of belt **10**. For example, the material used to form panel **18** and shroud **20** can provide flexibility to easily move the divider **16** so that the user has direct line of sight to the device with the primary compartment **14** regardless of whether the device is in the front portion **14A** or the rear portion **14B** of compartment **14**. Contrarily, a fixed divider can obstruct the line of sight, particularly when in dark, small and tight spaces.

(50) The configuration of belt **10** can greatly facilitate cleaning efforts. Belt **10** enables cleaning to be more accessible and efficient. A user can easily reach into the primary compartment without hindrance due to the construction of divider **16**, ensuring thorough cleaning practices are upheld.

The presence of and combination of materials described herein minimizes the effort required to remove dirt, making the cleaning process more efficient.

(51) The pouch **12** presents an excellent space for customization and branding. This area offers high visibility, making it an ideal spot to display logos, company names, or decorative patterns. Belt **10** can serve as effective marketing tools, promoting brand recognition and creating a professional and cohesive atmosphere. Customization options can extend to various industries and settings, including corporate offices, hospitality venues, educational institutions, and public spaces, allowing organizations to leave a lasting impression on users. The curvature of the belt **10** on the exterior of pouch **12** or on the divider **16** can serve as a natural contour for incorporating logos or brand symbols. By aligning the logo with the pouch **12** or divider **16**, it can seamlessly follow the shape, creating a visually appealing and cohesive design. This not only reinforces brand identity but also enhances the overall aesthetics of the chair. The conforming curvature of belt **10** when worn by a user allows for creative and eye-catching logo placement, making it more noticeable and memorable to users. Belt **10** can also be utilized to accentuate brand colors. By applying the brand's signature colors to belt **10**, it creates a visually striking effect.

(52) Optionally, the belt **10** or **110** may additionally include one or more sensors to sense or gather data pertaining to the surrounding environment, the user's or wearer's activity level, or operation/location of the belt **10** or **110**. Some exemplary sensors capable of being electronically coupled with the belt **10** or **110** (either directly connected to the belt **10** or **110** or remotely connected thereto) may include but are not limited to: accelerometers sensing accelerations experienced during rotation, translation, velocity/speed, location traveled, elevation gained; gyroscopes sensing movements during angular orientation and/or rotation, and rotation; altimeters sensing barometric pressure, altitude change, terrain climbed, local pressure changes, submersion in liquid; impellers measuring the amount of fluid passing thereby; Global Positioning sensors sensing location, elevation, distance traveled, velocity/speed; audio sensors sensing local environmental sound levels, or voice detection; Photo/Light sensors sensing ambient light intensity, ambient, Day/night, UV exposure; TV/IR sensors sensing light wavelength; Temperature sensors sensing machine or motor temperature, ambient air temperature, and environmental temperature; and Moisture Sensors sensing surrounding moisture levels.

(53) The belt **10** or **110** may include wireless communication logic coupled to sensors on the belt **10** or **110**. The sensors gather data and provide the data to the wireless communication logic. Then, the wireless communication logic may transmit the data gathered from the sensors to a remote device, such as a user or wearer-worn fitness activity tracker. Thus, the wireless communication logic may be part of a broader communication system, in which one or several belts **10** or **110** may be networked together to report alerts and, more generally, to be accessed and controlled remotely. Depending on the types of transceivers installed in the belt **10** or **110**, the system may use a variety of protocols (e.g., Wifi, ZigBee, MiWi, Bluetooth) for communication. In one example, each of the belts **10** or **110** may have its own IP address and may communicate directly with a router or gateway. This would typically be the case if the communication protocol is WiFi.

(54) In another example, a point-to-point communication protocol like MiWi or ZigBee is used. One or more of the belts **10** or **110** may serve as a repeater, or the belts **10** or **110** may be connected together in a mesh network to relay signals from one belt **10** or **110** to the next. However, the individual belt **10** or **110** in this scheme typically would not have IP addresses of their own. Instead, one or more of the belts **10** or **110** communicates with a repeater that does have an IP address, or another type of address, identifier, or credential needed to communicate with an outside network. The repeater communicates with the router or gateway.

(55) In either communication scheme, the router or gateway communicates with a communication network, such as the Internet, although in some embodiments, the communication network may be a private network that uses transmission control protocol/internet protocol (TCP/IP) and other common Internet protocols but does not interface with the broader Internet, or does so only

selectively through a firewall.

(56) The system that receives and processes signals from belt **10** or **110** may differ from embodiment to embodiment. In one embodiment, alerts and signals from the belt **10** or **110** are sent through an e-mail or simple message service (SMS; text message) gateway so that they can be sent as e-mails or SMS text messages to a remote device, such as a smartphone, laptop, or tablet computer, monitored by a responsible individual, group of individuals, or department, such as a user of a fitness mobile application. Thus, if a particular belt **10** or **110** creates an alert because of a data point gathered by one or more sensors, that alert can be sent, in e-mail or SMS form, directly to the individual responsible for monitoring the user's fitness level. Of course, e-mail and SMS are only two examples of communication methods that may be used; in other embodiments, different forms of communication may be used.

(57) Various inventive concepts may be embodied as one or more methods, of which an example has been provided. The acts performed as part of the method may be ordered in any suitable way. Accordingly, embodiments may be constructed in which acts are performed in an order different than illustrated, which may include performing some acts simultaneously, even though shown as sequential acts in illustrative embodiments.

(58) While various inventive embodiments have been described and illustrated herein, those of ordinary skill in the art will readily envision a variety of other means and/or structures for performing the function and/or obtaining the results and/or one or more of the advantages described herein, and each of such variations and/or modifications is deemed to be within the scope of the inventive embodiments described herein. More generally, those skilled in the art will readily appreciate that all parameters, dimensions, materials, and configurations described herein are meant to be exemplary and that the actual parameters, dimensions, materials, and/or configurations will depend upon the specific application or applications for which the inventive teachings is/are used. Those skilled in the art will recognize, or be able to ascertain using no more than routine experimentation, many equivalents to the specific inventive embodiments described herein. It is, therefore, to be understood that the foregoing embodiments are presented by way of example only and that, within the scope of the appended claims and equivalents thereto, inventive embodiments may be practiced otherwise than as specifically described and claimed. Inventive embodiments of the present disclosure are directed to each individual feature, system, article, material, kit, and/or method described herein. In addition, any combination of two or more such features, systems, articles, materials, kits, and/or methods, if such features, systems, articles, materials, kits, and/or methods are not mutually inconsistent, is included within the inventive scope of the present disclosure.

(59) All definitions, as defined and used herein, should be understood to control over dictionary definitions, definitions in documents incorporated by reference, and/or ordinary meanings of the defined terms.

(60) The articles “a” and “an,” as used herein in the specification and in the claims, unless clearly indicated to the contrary, should be understood to mean “at least one.” The phrase “and/or,” as used herein in the specification and in the claims (if at all), should be understood to mean “either or both” of the elements so conjoined, i.e., elements that are conjunctively present in some cases and disjunctively present in other cases. Multiple elements listed with “and/or” should be construed in the same fashion, i.e., “one or more” of the elements so conjoined. Other elements may optionally be present other than the elements specifically identified by the “and/or” clause, whether related or unrelated to those elements specifically identified. Thus, as a non-limiting example, a reference to “A and/or B”, when used in conjunction with open-ended language such as “comprising” can refer, in one embodiment, to A only (optionally including elements other than B); in another embodiment, to B only (optionally including elements other than A); in yet another embodiment, to both A and B (optionally including other elements); etc. As used herein in the specification and in the claims, “or” should be understood to have the same meaning as “and/or” as defined above. For

example, when separating items in a list, “or” or “and/or” shall be interpreted as being inclusive, i.e., the inclusion of at least one, but also including more than one, of a number or list of elements, and, optionally, additional unlisted items. Only terms clearly indicated to the contrary, such as “only one of” or “exactly one of,” or, when used in the claims, “consisting of,” will refer to the inclusion of exactly one element of a number or list of elements. In general, the term “or” as used herein shall only be interpreted as indicating exclusive alternatives (i.e. “one or the other but not both”) when preceded by terms of exclusivity, such as “either,” “one of,” “only one of,” or “exactly one of.” “Consisting essentially of,” when used in the claims, shall have its ordinary meaning as used in the field of patent law.

(61) As used herein in the specification and in the claims, the phrase “at least one,” in reference to a list of one or more elements, should be understood to mean at least one element selected from any one or more of the elements in the list of elements, but not necessarily including at least one of each and every element specifically listed within the list of elements and not excluding any combinations of elements in the list of elements. This definition also allows that elements may optionally be present other than the elements specifically identified within the list of elements to which the phrase “at least one” refers, whether related or unrelated to those elements specifically identified. Thus, as a non-limiting example, “at least one of A and B” (or, equivalently, “at least one of A or B,” or, equivalently “at least one of A and/or B”) can refer, in one embodiment, to at least one, optionally including more than one, A, with no B present (and optionally including elements other than B); in another embodiment, to at least one, optionally including more than one, B, with no A present (and optionally including elements other than A); in yet another embodiment, to at least one, optionally including more than one, A, and at least one, optionally including more than one, B (and optionally including other elements); etc.

(62) While components of the present disclosure are described herein in relation to each other, it is possible for one of the components disclosed herein to include inventive subject matter, if claimed alone or used alone. In keeping with the above example, if the disclosed embodiments teach the features of A and B, then there may be inventive subject matter in the combination of A and B, A alone, or B alone, unless otherwise stated herein.

(63) As used herein in the specification and in the claims, the term “effecting” or a phrase or claim element beginning with the term “effecting” should be understood to mean to cause something to happen or to bring something about. For example, effecting an event to occur may be caused by actions of a first party even though a second party actually performed the event or had the event occur to the second party. Stated otherwise, effecting refers to one party giving another party the tools, objects, or resources to cause an event to occur. Thus, in this example a claim element of “effecting an event to occur” would mean that a first party is giving a second party the tools or resources needed for the second party to perform the event, however the affirmative single action is the responsibility of the first party to provide the tools or resources to cause said event to occur.

(64) When a feature or element is herein referred to as being “on” another feature or element, it can be directly on the other feature or element or intervening features and/or elements may also be present. In contrast, when a feature or element is referred to as being “directly on” another feature or element, there are no intervening features or elements present. It will also be understood that, when a feature or element is referred to as being “connected”, “attached” or “coupled” to another feature or element, it can be directly connected, attached or coupled to the other feature or element or intervening features or elements may be present. In contrast, when a feature or element is referred to as being “directly connected”, “directly attached” or “directly coupled” to another feature or element, there are no intervening features or elements present. Although described or shown with respect to one embodiment, the features and elements so described or shown can apply to other embodiments. It will also be appreciated by those of skill in the art that references to a structure or feature that is disposed “adjacent” another feature may have portions that overlap or underlie the adjacent feature.

(65) Spatially relative terms, such as “under”, “below”, “lower”, “over”, “upper”, “above”, “behind”, “in front of”, and the like, may be used herein for ease of description to describe one element or feature's relationship to another element(s) or feature(s) as illustrated in the figures. It will be understood that the spatially relative terms are intended to encompass different orientations of the device in use or operation in addition to the orientation depicted in the figures. For example, if a device in the figures is inverted, elements described as “under” or “beneath” other elements or features would then be oriented “over” the other elements or features. Thus, the exemplary term “under” can encompass both an orientation of over and under. The device may be otherwise oriented (rotated 90 degrees or at other orientations) and the spatially relative descriptors used herein interpreted accordingly. Similarly, the terms “upwardly”, “downwardly”, “vertical”, “horizontal”, “lateral”, “transverse”, “longitudinal”, and the like are used herein for the purpose of explanation only unless specifically indicated otherwise.

(66) Although the terms “first” and “second” may be used herein to describe various features/elements, these features/elements should not be limited by these terms, unless the context indicates otherwise. These terms may be used to distinguish one feature/element from another feature/element. Thus, a first feature/element discussed herein could be termed a second feature/element, and similarly, a second feature/element discussed herein could be termed a first feature/element without departing from the teachings of the present invention.

(67) An embodiment is an implementation or example of the present disclosure. Reference in the specification to “an embodiment,” “one embodiment,” “some embodiments,” “one particular embodiment,” “an exemplary embodiment,” or “other embodiments,” or the like, means that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiments is included in at least some embodiments, but not necessarily all embodiments, of the invention. The various appearances “an embodiment,” “one embodiment,” “some embodiments,” “one particular embodiment,” “an exemplary embodiment,” or “other embodiments,” or the like, are not necessarily all referring to the same embodiments.

(68) If this specification states a component, feature, structure, or characteristic “may”, “might”, or “could” be included, that particular component, feature, structure, or characteristic is not required to be included. If the specification or claim refers to “a” or “an” element, that does not mean there is only one of the element. If the specification or claims refer to “an additional” element, that does not preclude there being more than one of the additional element.

(69) As used herein in the specification and claims, including as used in the examples and unless otherwise expressly specified, all numbers may be read as if prefaced by the word “about” or “approximately,” even if the term does not expressly appear. The phrase “about” or “approximately” may be used when describing magnitude and/or position to indicate that the value and/or position described is within a reasonable expected range of values and/or positions. For example, a numeric value may have a value that is $\pm 0.1\%$ of the stated value (or range of values), $\pm 1\%$ of the stated value (or range of values), $\pm 2\%$ of the stated value (or range of values), $\pm 5\%$ of the stated value (or range of values), $\pm 10\%$ of the stated value (or range of values), etc. Any numerical range recited herein is intended to include all sub-ranges subsumed therein.

(70) Additionally, the method of performing the present disclosure may occur in a sequence different than those described herein. Accordingly, no sequence of the method should be read as a limitation unless explicitly stated. It is recognizable that performing some of the steps of the method in a different order could achieve a similar result.

(71) In the claims, as well as in the specification above, all transitional phrases such as “comprising,” “including,” “carrying,” “having,” “containing,” “involving,” “holding,” “composed of,” and the like are to be understood to be open-ended, i.e., to mean including but not limited to. Only the transitional phrases “consisting of” and “consisting essentially of” shall be closed or semi-closed transitional phrases, respectively.

(72) To the extent that the present disclosure has utilized the term “invention” in various titles or

sections of this specification, this term was included as required by the formatting requirements of word document submissions pursuant the guidelines/requirements of the United States Patent and Trademark Office and shall not, in any manner, be considered a disavowal of any subject matter. (73) In the foregoing description, certain terms have been used for brevity, clearness, and understanding. No unnecessary limitations are to be implied therefrom beyond the requirement of the prior art because such terms are used for descriptive purposes and are intended to be broadly construed.

(74) Moreover, the description and illustration of various embodiments of the disclosure are examples and the disclosure is not limited to the exact details shown or described.

Claims

1. A running belt comprising: a pouch forming a primary compartment, and the primary compartment is adapted to carry a device; a divider within the pouch to divide the primary compartment into a first portion and a second portion, the divider comprising a panel surrounded by a first material; and an adjustable belt, wherein the adjustable belt is operable to retain the pouch about a portion of a user's body and the adjustable belt is operatively connected to the divider to retain the device within the compartment of the pouch the divider having a first end and a second end, wherein the first end of the divider and the second end of the divider are indirectly coupled with respective ends of the pouch and directly connected to the adjustable belt.
2. The running belt of claim 1, further comprising: a pocket defined within the divider between the panel and the first material, and the pocket within the divider is adapted to carry an item that is smaller than the device.
3. The running belt of claim 2, further comprising: a first surface on the panel; a second surface on the panel, wherein the second surface faces an opposite direction as the first surface; and a first portion of the first material proximate the first surface on the panel, wherein the first portion of the first material defines an opening that is selectively opened and closed.
4. The running belt of claim 2, further comprising: a zipper on the first portion of the first material that effectuates the opening to be selectively opened and closed, wherein the zipper is laterally aligned.
5. The running belt of claim 2, further comprising: a first surface on the panel, wherein a first portion of the pocket within the divider is defined between the first surface of the panel and a front portion of the first material.
6. The running belt of claim 1, further comprising: wherein the pouch comprises a second material that is different than the first material.
7. The running belt of claim 6, wherein the first material comprises elastane and the second material comprises neoprene; and wherein the panel comprises polypropylene (PP).
8. The running belt of claim 1, wherein the adjustable belt is connected to respective ends of the panel within the divider that is adapted to allow the divider to stretch and allow the pouch to stretch.
9. The running belt of claim 1, wherein the divider further comprises: a top edge and a bottom edge on the panel; a first end and second end on the panel; wherein the first end and the second end on the panel are indirectly coupled to the first material, and the first material freely surrounds the top edge and the bottom edge on the panel.
10. The running belt of claim 9, wherein the first material that freely surrounds the panel defines a front portion of a pocket and a rear portion of the pocket within the divider.
11. The running belt of claim 1, further comprising: a top of the divider and a bottom of the divider; wherein the pouch freely surrounds the top of the divider and the bottom of the divider, and wherein there is no connection of the bottom of the divider to the pouch such that the first portion of the primary compartment is in open communication with the second portion of the primary

compartment below the divider, and wherein there is no connection of the top of the divider to the pouch such that the first portion of the primary compartment is in open communication with the second portion of the primary compartment above the divider.

12. A running belt has a pouch that defines a primary compartment sized to receive at least a smartphone therein, and there is a divider within the compartment to divide the compartment into a front portion and a rear portion, wherein at least one of the front portion and the rear portion is adapted to retain the smartphone therein, and the divider defines an interior pocket that is divided into at least two portions by a panel within the pocket of the divider, and the pocket is sized to receive an item that is smaller than the smartphone therein, and the panel maintains a substantially constant shape of the divider when the smartphone is inserted into or removed from the primary compartment, and the divider is directly connected to respective ends of an adjustable belt.

13. A method comprising: donning a belt having a pouch defining a primary compartment and having a divider located within the primary compartment, wherein the divider divides the primary compartment into a first portion and a second portion of the primary compartment; wherein the divider has a first end and a second end, wherein the first end of the divider and the second end of the divider are indirectly coupled with respective ends of the pouch and directly connected to the belt; selectively inserting a device into either one of the first portion of the primary compartment or the second portion of the primary compartment; adjusting the belt, wherein respective ends of the belt are directly connected to the divider within the primary compartment; and retaining the device within the primary compartment in response to adjustment of the belt.

14. The method of claim 13, further comprising: opening the divider to reveal a pocket within the divider; and inserting an item into the divider, wherein the item is smaller than the device.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein the divider includes a panel that divides the pocket into a first portion and the second portion, the method further comprising: selectively inserting the item into either one of the first portion of the pocket or the second portion of the pocket.

16. The method of claim 15, further comprising: stretching a first material that surrounds the panel and defines the divider in response to insertion of the item, wherein the panel has a top edge and a bottom edge, and has a first end and second end, and wherein the first end and the second end on the panel are directly or indirectly coupled to the first material, and the first material freely surrounds the top edge and the bottom edge on the panel; stretching a second material that forms the pouch in response to insertion of the device, wherein the divider has a top edge and a bottom edge, and the divider has a first end and second end, and wherein the first end and the second end on the divider are directly or indirectly coupled to the second material, and the second material freely surrounds the top edge and the bottom edge on the divider.

17. The method of claim 14, wherein opening the divider to reveal a pocket within the divider is accomplished by unzipping a laterally aligned zipper on a frontal portion of the divider.

18. The method of claim 14, further comprising: flexing a panel located within the pocket of the divider prior to inserting the item into the pocket of the divider, wherein the panel is flexed prior to inserting the device into either one of the first portion of the primary compartment or the second portion of the primary compartment, wherein the panel is formed from polypropylene (PP).

19. The method of claim 13, further comprising: opening the pouch via an overlap opening on a frontal portion of the pouch to provide access to the primary compartment.

20. The method of claim 13, further comprising: maintaining an exterior profile shape of the divider via a panel located within the pocket of the divider when the item is inserted into the pocket of the divider and when the item is removed from the pocket of the divider.
